

## SK2222 V24 Varieties of Democracy and Democratization

The course was held for the 11<sup>th</sup> time since 2015, in Spring 2025. Course responsible were Dr. Fabio Angiolillo and Professor Staffan I. Lindberg. Others teaching in 2025 were and Assist. Professor Valeriya Mechkova and PhD student Martin Lundsteat. Wilma Holmestrand was course administrator.

The course content was a little further adjusted this year to reflect the growing trend of autocratization in the world and the accompanying state of the art in the scientific literature. The graded assignments were one multiple choice exam to stimulate and evaluate reading of the course literature early in the course period; one group-presentation in seminar form; and one short paper on a topic among a list of predefined ones; alongside the final course paper. Among the new structure of the course there was: collecting all information to students in one full document (extending the course guide to become a traditional, full-blown syllabus), including all detailed instructions for all graded assignments.

The planning of the course this year was much better than previously, and one of the key aspects that help this was to conduct a joint review of the content of all lectures together to enhance the coherence and structure of the material communicated to the students (new); connect the group presentation assignment with the following short paper assignment in a clear way (new); a new seminar on “how to write a final paper” (new); revised instructions and expectations for the final course paper to exclude empirical analysis and focus on theory/literature, study design, data, and methods (new); standardized time students get with their respective final paper-advisor so all students get the same amount of feedback and advising (new). As a result, the teaching organization and delivery was much better, and students really enjoyed the course throughout. We will keep the same structure and organization for next year’s iteration of the course.

### **Completion Rate**

22 students registered this year compared to 21 in 2024 (inclusive of 2 re-registered) out of which 18 (82%) completed the course by the time of writing (much higher than previous years, where the completion rate was 67% in 2022-2024). 6 failed or did not submit (U), 4 passed (G), and 12 received a high pass (VG). For 2024 it was 0 U, 9 G, and 5 VG, marking important gains in students’ overall performance, especially in achieving the highest scores.

### **Student Evaluations**

11 out of 22 students (50% - the attached says 24 respondents but we only had 22 registered) answered the course evaluation. Evaluations are extremely good, with 91% of respondents scoring the overall course as either “rather good” or “very good”. Teachers were evaluated extremely good as well, with 91% of respondents saying “very good”. In general, respondents have almost never scored the course lower than “neither good nor bad”, testifying the highly positive students’ response to all aspects related to the course, from its organization to all parts of the delivery.

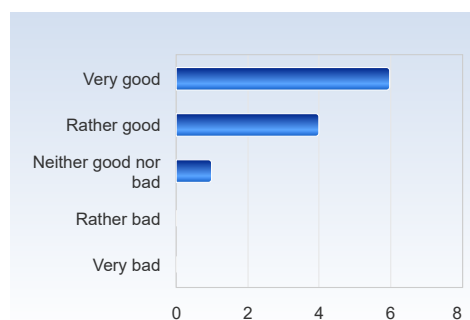


## SK2222 V25 Varianter på demokrati och demokratisering

Respondents: 24  
Answer Count: 11  
Answer Frequency: 45,83 %

### Overall, how would you assess the course?

| Overall, how would you assess the course? | Number of responses |
|-------------------------------------------|---------------------|
| Very good                                 | 6 (54,5%)           |
| Rather good                               | 4 (36,4%)           |
| Neither good nor bad                      | 1 (9,1%)            |
| Rather bad                                | 0 (0,0%)            |
| Very bad                                  | 0 (0,0%)            |
| Total                                     | 11 (100,0%)         |



|                                           | Mean | Standard Deviation | Coefficient of Variation | Min | Lower Quartile | Median | Upper Quartile | Max |
|-------------------------------------------|------|--------------------|--------------------------|-----|----------------|--------|----------------|-----|
| Overall, how would you assess the course? | 4,5  | 0,7                | 15,4 %                   | 3,0 | 4,0            | 5,0    | 5,0            | 5,0 |

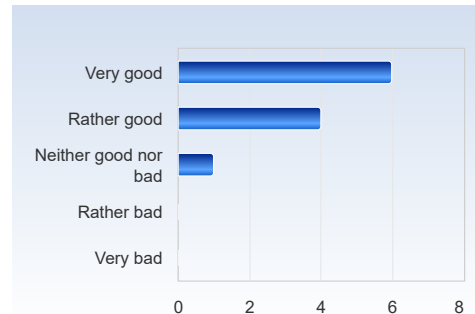
#### Comment

I do think the class was well done and everything so this reflects more my personal preference for the class and less the quality of the teaching



## Overall, how would you assess the lectures?

| Overall, how would you assess the lectures? | Number of responses |
|---------------------------------------------|---------------------|
| Very good                                   | 6 (54,5%)           |
| Rather good                                 | 4 (36,4%)           |
| Neither good nor bad                        | 1 (9,1%)            |
| Rather bad                                  | 0 (0,0%)            |
| Very bad                                    | 0 (0,0%)            |
| Total                                       | 11 (100,0%)         |



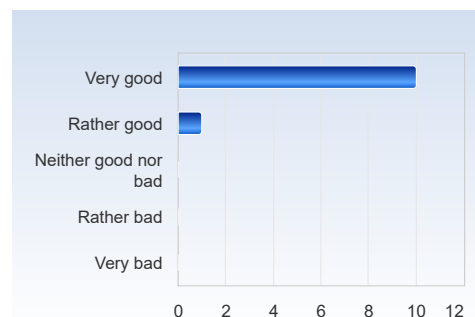
|                                             | Mean | Standard Deviation | Coefficient of Variation | Min | Lower Quartile | Median | Upper Quartile | Max |
|---------------------------------------------|------|--------------------|--------------------------|-----|----------------|--------|----------------|-----|
| Overall, how would you assess the lectures? | 4,5  | 0,7                | 15,4 %                   | 3,0 | 4,0            | 5,0    | 5,0            | 5,0 |

### Comment

The lecturers were very engaged and always tried to engage the student to input their own knowledge and arguments

## Overall, how would you assess the teachers?

| Overall, how would you assess the teachers? | Number of responses |
|---------------------------------------------|---------------------|
| Very good                                   | 10 (90,9%)          |
| Rather good                                 | 1 (9,1%)            |
| Neither good nor bad                        | 0 (0,0%)            |
| Rather bad                                  | 0 (0,0%)            |
| Very bad                                    | 0 (0,0%)            |
| Total                                       | 11 (100,0%)         |



|                                             | Mean | Standard Deviation | Coefficient of Variation | Min | Lower Quartile | Median | Upper Quartile | Max |
|---------------------------------------------|------|--------------------|--------------------------|-----|----------------|--------|----------------|-----|
| Overall, how would you assess the teachers? | 4,9  | 0,3                | 6,1 %                    | 4,0 | 5,0            | 5,0    | 5,0            | 5,0 |

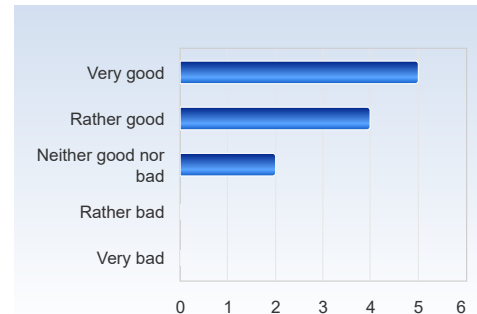
### Comment

It's great to hear directly from the people behind the literature/research.



## Overall, how would you assess the literature?

| Overall, how would you assess the literature? | Number of responses |
|-----------------------------------------------|---------------------|
| Very good                                     | 5 (45,5%)           |
| Rather good                                   | 4 (36,4%)           |
| Neither good nor bad                          | 2 (18,2%)           |
| Rather bad                                    | 0 (0,0%)            |
| Very bad                                      | 0 (0,0%)            |
| Total                                         | 11 (100,0%)         |



|                                               | Mean | Standard Deviation | Coefficient of Variation | Min | Lower Quartile | Median | Upper Quartile | Max |
|-----------------------------------------------|------|--------------------|--------------------------|-----|----------------|--------|----------------|-----|
| Overall, how would you assess the literature? | 4,3  | 0,8                | 18,4 %                   | 3,0 | 4,0            | 4,0    | 5,0            | 5,0 |

### Comment

I like that it is very up to date with current events etc! Makes it very interesting to read!

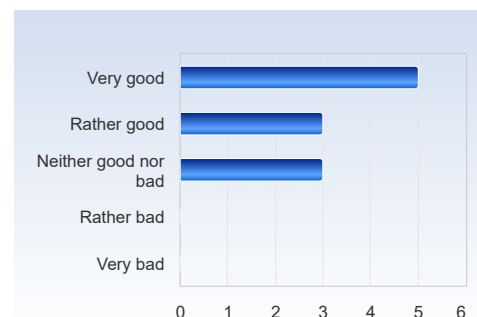
Very good & interesting literature but also a lot, especially in the first 2 weeks

Prior to the Multiple Choice Exam, the amount of literature we had to read was obviously very high. I understand that this is also part of the challenge - comprehending a lot of information in a limited amount of time - but it felt like it's not even possible to read everything, which was quite frustrating.

After, I was felt burned out from reading, which is why I didn't read as much anymore. Maybe this could be balanced out a bit more.

## Overall, how would you assess the seminars?

| Overall, how would you assess the seminars? | Number of responses |
|---------------------------------------------|---------------------|
| Very good                                   | 5 (45,5%)           |
| Rather good                                 | 3 (27,3%)           |
| Neither good nor bad                        | 3 (27,3%)           |
| Rather bad                                  | 0 (0,0%)            |
| Very bad                                    | 0 (0,0%)            |
| Total                                       | 11 (100,0%)         |



|                                             | Mean | Standard Deviation | Coefficient of Variation | Min | Lower Quartile | Median | Upper Quartile | Max |
|---------------------------------------------|------|--------------------|--------------------------|-----|----------------|--------|----------------|-----|
| Overall, how would you assess the seminars? | 4,2  | 0,9                | 20,9 %                   | 3,0 | 3,5            | 4,0    | 5,0            | 5,0 |

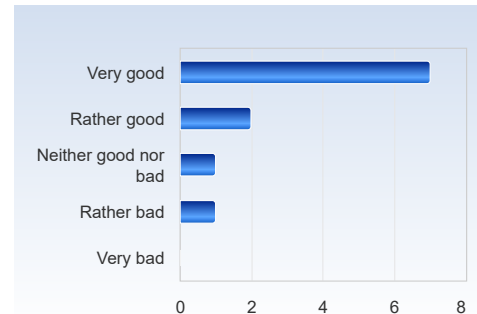
### Comment

overall they were good, and interesting. I did like the workshop on democratic resilience, but it felt a bit oddly placed in the schedule. The way we debated, it would perhaps have made more sense to have it more towards the beginning of the course as a starting point for questions and research problems to tackle.



## Overall, how would you assess the course paper tutorials?

| Overall, how would you assess the course paper tutorials? | Number of responses |
|-----------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|
| Very good                                                 | 7 (63,6%)           |
| Rather good                                               | 2 (18,2%)           |
| Neither good nor bad                                      | 1 (9,1%)            |
| Rather bad                                                | 1 (9,1%)            |
| Very bad                                                  | 0 (0,0%)            |
| Total                                                     | 11 (100,0%)         |



|                                                           | Mean | Standard Deviation | Coefficient of Variation | Min | Lower Quartile | Median | Upper Quartile | Max |
|-----------------------------------------------------------|------|--------------------|--------------------------|-----|----------------|--------|----------------|-----|
| Overall, how would you assess the course paper tutorials? | 4,4  | 1,0                | 23,5 %                   | 2,0 | 4,0            | 5,0    | 5,0            | 5,0 |

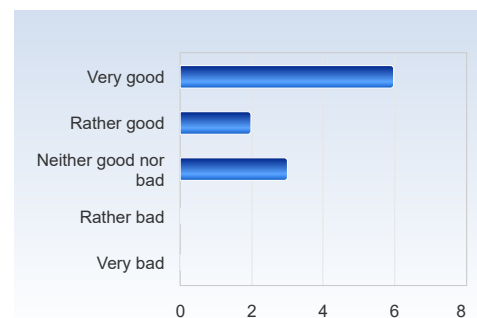
### Comment

I was unable to attend.

Very helpful, there was enough time to discuss and receive actual help with our final paper if this refers to the feedback sessions, they were very nice and helpful

## Overall, how would you assess the exam (course paper)?

| Overall, how would you assess the exam (course paper)? | Number of responses |
|--------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|
| Very good                                              | 6 (54,5%)           |
| Rather good                                            | 2 (18,2%)           |
| Neither good nor bad                                   | 3 (27,3%)           |
| Rather bad                                             | 0 (0,0%)            |
| Very bad                                               | 0 (0,0%)            |
| Total                                                  | 11 (100,0%)         |





|                                                        | Mean | Standard Deviation | Coefficient of Variation | Min | Lower Quartile | Median | Upper Quartile | Max |
|--------------------------------------------------------|------|--------------------|--------------------------|-----|----------------|--------|----------------|-----|
| Overall, how would you assess the exam (course paper)? | 4,3  | 0,9                | 21,2 %                   | 3,0 | 3,5            | 5,0    | 5,0            | 5,0 |

#### Comment

The sketch and the outline are so close together, that I could not really develop it further a lot before the supervision meeting. Given that this is the only chance for input from the supervisor before the final deadline, I feel like I couldn't profit enough from their expertise.

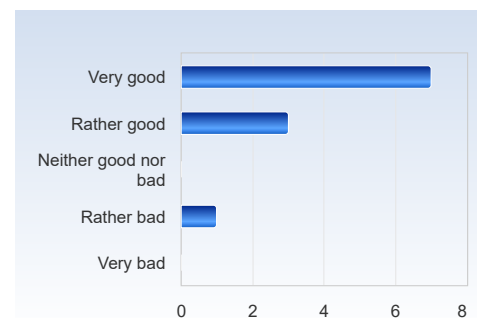
I really like how you have structured the paper and the preparations for it! Both the seminars and the feedback sessions, on the paper outline as well as the individual meeting, were extremely helpful, and I feel that I learned a great deal through the process.

I would say that the multiple choice exam was not structured in a good way. Although I understand the purpose of the exam, it would have been better to have more open questions where you could reflect rather than just memorizing them.

### How would you assess the organization of the course, including the information on Canvas (information, schedule, administration)?

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|                      | Number of responses |
|----------------------|---------------------|
| Very good            | 7 (63,6%)           |
| Rather good          | 3 (27,3%)           |
| Neither good nor bad | 0 (0,0%)            |
| Rather bad           | 1 (9,1%)            |
| Very bad             | 0 (0,0%)            |
| Total                | 11 (100,0%)         |



|                                                                                                                                   | Mean | Standard Deviation | Coefficient of Variation | Min | Lower Quartile | Median | Upper Quartile | Max |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------|--------------------|--------------------------|-----|----------------|--------|----------------|-----|
| How would you assess the organization of the course, including the information on Canvas (information, schedule, administration)? | 4,5  | 0,9                | 21,0 %                   | 2,0 | 4,0            | 5,0    | 5,0            | 5,0 |



#### Comment

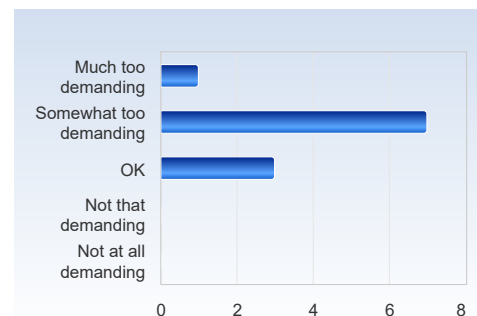
Multiple times, there was contradicting information on the course guide / Canvas / Slides, which could have easily been prevented.

Also, I always appreciated a heads-up about what we were expected to do in seminars or workshops.

For the policy brief, I felt like the guidelines on the course guide were not enough. I didn't really comprehend what was expected, and the table with research questions and topic areas was not intuitive to me. The lecture with Staffan, where he explained it to us, was very important.

### What is your assessment of the amount of work you have been requested to carry out during the course? Do you consider the course:

| What is your assessment of the amount of work you have been requested to carry out during the course? Do you consider the course: | Number of responses |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|
| Much too demanding                                                                                                                | 1 (9,1%)            |
| Somewhat too demanding                                                                                                            | 7 (63,6%)           |
| OK                                                                                                                                | 3 (27,3%)           |
| Not that demanding                                                                                                                | 0 (0,0%)            |
| Not at all demanding                                                                                                              | 0 (0,0%)            |
| Total                                                                                                                             | 11 (100,0%)         |



|                                                                                                                                   | Mean | Standard Deviation | Coefficient of Variation | Min | Lower Quartile | Median | Upper Quartile | Max |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------|--------------------|--------------------------|-----|----------------|--------|----------------|-----|
| What is your assessment of the amount of work you have been requested to carry out during the course? Do you consider the course: | 3,8  | 0,6                | 15,8 %                   | 3,0 | 3,5            | 4,0    | 4,0            | 5,0 |

#### Comment

It's definitely one of the more demanding courses I have completed.

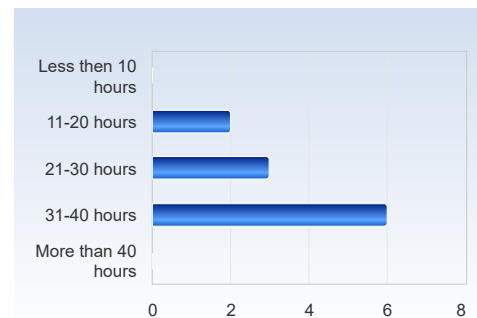
Not too demanding in terms of difficulty but in terms of the amount of readings & assignments

More demanding than other courses but for 15 credits still fair.



## On average, approximately how much time do you spend on coursework, both in and outside of the classroom, per week?

| On average, approximately how much time do you spend on coursework, both in and outside of the classroom, per week? | Number of responses |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|
| Less than 10 hours                                                                                                  | 0 (0,0%)            |
| 11-20 hours                                                                                                         | 2 (18,2%)           |
| 21-30 hours                                                                                                         | 3 (27,3%)           |
| 31-40 hours                                                                                                         | 6 (54,5%)           |
| More than 40 hours                                                                                                  | 0 (0,0%)            |
| Total                                                                                                               | 11 (100,0%)         |



|                                                                                                                     | Mean | Standard Deviation | Coefficient of Variation | Min | Lower Quartile | Median | Upper Quartile | Max |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------|--------------------|--------------------------|-----|----------------|--------|----------------|-----|
| On average, approximately how much time do you spend on coursework, both in and outside of the classroom, per week? | 3,4  | 0,8                | 24,1 %                   | 2,0 | 3,0            | 4,0    | 4,0            | 4,0 |

## Would you say that you had an “eureka moment” during the course, i.e. a time when you suddenly realized something that you previously did not understand or was aware of? If so, please make a short comment about it below.

Would you say that you had an “eureka moment” during the course, i.e. a time when you suddenly realized something that you previously did not understand or was aware of? If so, please make a short comment about it below.

Yes! Interpreting Bell and U-turns and the diverse indicators related to Measuring, how relevant variables are made and the associated complexities

No

No



## Do you have any additional points of view you would like to express?

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Presentation : The groups should be distributed more equally. I was in a group of two and talking to others I realized that I had to put in a lot more work into it. This might have been due to my partner, but we were not really able to split up the work among us, so it felt like I had to do the whole presentation by myself. It was pretty frustrating.

Democracy Workshop : This was a nice addition. During lectures, it's usually always the same people who speak up, but our two-hour conversation allowed for almost everyone to contribute in a relaxed, engaging discussion. Props to Martin for a great moderation of the discussion.

Policy Brief : I also really liked this as a new challenge, given that I have never written anything similar before.

I would have liked that more information was provided on the exams. The policy brief was very confusing so next time maybe there should be clear information.

Maybe don't schedule the group presentation right after easter as many students left Gothenburg the week before.

Would have been nice to get the feedback on the policy brief. The final paper is to many words.

No

- I thought the more deliberative seminar we had with Martin was very fun for me personally but at the same time I also didn't really see the value in it for the course. I think it would have been better to have it either as an introductory session to the course OR communicate a clear goal for the session instead of just jumping from topic to topic and debating everything for a bit (with mostly always the same three people talking).

- The academic writing session felt unnecessary because it was just a replication of the ASK lecture, which at least the MAPS people already had before. Maybe if it had been more tailored to the final course paper it would have been more helpful.

- Overall, it was the course I was looking forward to the most in the program (and one of the reasons I applied for the program) and I was not disappointed. I learned a lot content-wise in the area I am most interested in and feel like I also learned some new skills (e.g. I never had to write a policy brief before) which I appreciate a lot! A great course, great lecturers, and very happy I could attend it :)

Regarding the feedback of the policy brief, it would be nice to actually have it online that way you can go back to it more easily in the future without having to keep the printed version. While i do understand, that the writing and marking on the physical brief itself makes sense and is probably more intuitive, but feedback is only so helpful if you can't actually read a thing (somewhat ironically really given what some of the feedback was about).

It would be great if it is possible to integrate a modules on how V-Dem variables are made. More workshops on making datasets, creating relevant variables e.g. Demscore workshop that we had. I think that this would be helpful for students to understand lot of the information included in the literature papers

Finally, we want to ask for your help in our work to promote equality. The Department of Political Science works actively to prevent discrimination. Central to this is that we gain knowledge about whether, and if so, how, there are risks of harassment and discrimination, so that we can take preventive measures. If you think back on your time as a student with us from such a perspective, have you experienced contexts or situations where you think there is a certain risk for harassment and discrimination? If so, please describe these contexts or situations.

You may read more about equality treatment at GU here: [Discrimination and harassment | Student Portal \(gu.se\)](#)

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